The 3 Checks

Three decisions an AI fleet can't make for you. Run them before you spend the compute.

@OneResearchFleet
Episode 1 · One Researcher, One Research Fleet
Free to use, print and share

1 Which question?

Before you start a project, or before you turn a result into a paper.

- [ ] Who actually cares? Name a person, an industry, or a decision that depends on it.
- [ ] If it works, what changes?
- [ ] Can I write a one-line title that makes someone want to read it?

Fail any one → it's a foundation, not a headline.

Method is credibility; it isn't the finding. Then let a cheap model attack the claim. Each time it survives, it gets narrower and harder to argue with.

MY ONE-LINE TITLE

WHO CARES / WHAT CHANGES

2 Could it change my next decision?

Before every run: simulation, experiment, or overnight AI job.

- [ ] List the results that could come back.
- [ ] For each one, write what you would do differently.
- [ ] Compute, money and your attention are all limited. Which one is the bottleneck right now?

No possible result changes what you do → don't run it. It's decoration.

Wide end	Survivors	Narrow end
cheap, fast checks on everything	expensive simulation	real experiment + your attention

IF THE RESULT IS... → I WILL...

BOTTLENECK THIS WEEK

3 Kill criteria first

Before you look at any result.

- [ ] Write down what would prove it, and what would kill it. Date it.
- [ ] Send the AI to find counter-examples, not to prove you right.
- [ ] Too clean, too confident, too good? Trace it back to its inputs and assumptions before you believe it.

A result that good is a question, not an answer.

AI makes trying cheap. It also makes you wrong faster, and more convincingly. What catches it is your judgment of what's physically possible.

It holds if

It's dead if

Written on